Findings Chelsea FCW

Clustering results

At k = 2, Chelsea was safely clustered with front-footed teams. Then at k = 3 and k = 4, Chelsea was safely clustered with central combiners.

Like its cluster

Chelsea stood out for final third entries via carries and touches in the final third in middle areas. They also attempted many through balls, and for completed passes into the box, fewer of them are crosses. A higher share of their shots was during delayed set piece situations. They were also active with counterpress actions in opposition half.

Unlike its cluster

They attempted more crosses than most central combiners do, while more of their final third entries via carries were done via the left. A lower share of their shots was under transition.

Pitch profile

A fourth of their attacks went centrally. They attacked slightly more on the left side than on the right.

Formations and typical XI

Chelsea mainly used the 4-2-3-1 formation, followed by 4-4-2. They used back three formations in 22% and wingerless formations in 19% of the minutes, with 3-4-1-2 and 3-4-2-1 being their common options.

For their main formation 4-2-3-1, Sophie Ingle and Erin Cuthbert as the double pivot midfielders, Jessica Carter at one of the center back positions, Niamh Charles at left back, and Guro Reiten at left wing are more consistent positions. Other positions saw significant rotations throughout the season.

Similar teams

Bayern was the only team genuinely close to Chelsea in terms of squad, while Chelsea's style was the closest to Levante Badalona and Napoli. Overall, these three teams are the only ones that are close to Chelsea.

Appendix

The full Chelsea team report (PDF).